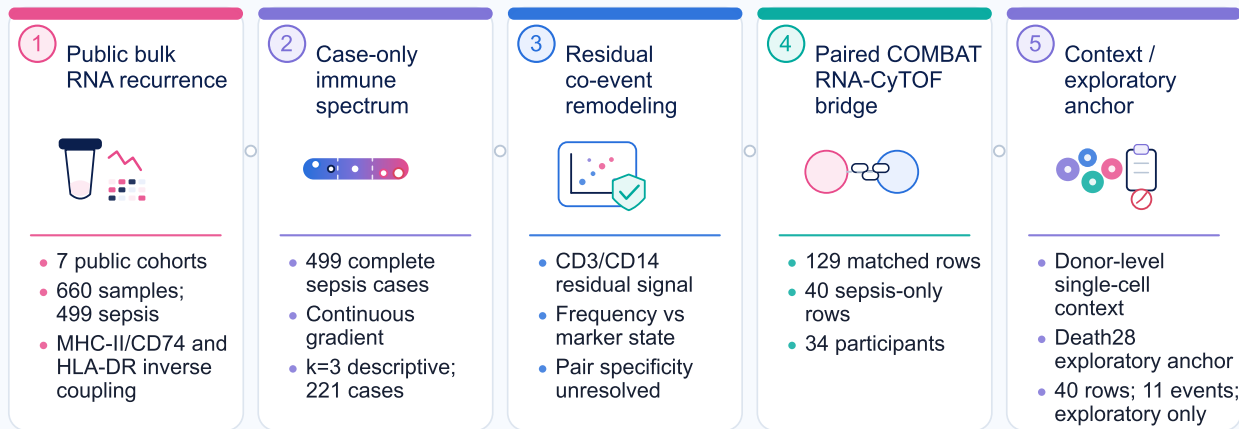


Study architecture and claim-boundary map

Association and sensitivity evidence; no causal or predictive modeling.

A Evidence hierarchy



B Locked interpretation



Inflammatory/MHC-II decoupling is associated with a prespecified residual CD3/CD14 co-event signal in paired sepsis samples

Association-only, artifact-aware, non-predictive interpretation

C Claim boundaries

Allowed

- ✓ Cross-cohort recurrence
- ✓ Activation-state remodeling
- ✓ Paired RNA-CyTOF bridge
- ✓ Computational sensitivity

Excluded

- ✗ Causal mechanism
- ✗ Validated endotype
- ✗ Therapeutic recommendation
- ✗ Physical CD3/CD14 complex
- ✗ Clinical prediction model